

Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." Items, listed by committee, are summarized as follows:

AGENDA

The committee discussed the importance of the General Service Conference Inventory Compendium and the Additional Recommendations/Suggestions section, encouraging all Conference members to review this section for possible actions locally, regionally and at future Conferences; after discussion of the trustees' report regarding the Conference Agenda Committee and the agenda selection process, it was agreed that the actions of the Conference Agenda Committee are matters of policy not just routine programming and that the committee name should remain the same.

ARCHIVES¹

Through area assemblies and committee meetings, archives workshops, notices in *Box 4-5-9* and *Markings*, encouragement was suggested for A.A. groups to write or update their group histories, with the suggestion that the Archives service piece "Researching Group Histories" be distributed to G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s; suggestions were made to include additional resources to the Archives Workbook at its next printing.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

The committee considered a request to discontinue the pamphlet "Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W." and took no action, with the suggestion that the trustees' committee continue discussing the historical value of the pamphlet and the possibility of keeping it available to the Fellowship; ways of integrating technology into the professional exhibits were offered regarding the inclusion of digital response or QR codes for pamphlets and tabletop displays, as well as development of an audiovisual presentation for continuous screening at professional events; suggestions were made for items to be added to the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook, and the "Matrix of Individual Comments" was reviewed with the suggestion that proposed changes to material *not* under the purview of the C.P.C. committee be forwarded to the appropriate trustees' committees for appraisal.

CORRECTIONS

It was noted that an accompanying service piece in a 2014 Advisory Action for the video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" does not exist and so cannot be updated or revised; a suggestion was made to the trustees' Committee on Corrections to consider additional versions of the video "A

New Freedom" in varying lengths for different audiences in different settings; challenges regarding the expansion of the Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) in Canada were discussed, as were ways to attract more Spanish-speaking "outside" A.A. members to the service, while additions to the C.C.S. form (F-26) and the Corrections Kit and Workbook were suggested to the trustees' Committee on Corrections.

FINANCE

After discussion, no action was taken to increase the Suggested Delegate Area Contribution to the General Service Conference or to increase the one-time limit for individual bequests; it was suggested that G.S.O. consider additional ways, using technology, to convey the financial message contained in the flyer "The Seventh Tradition Fact Sheet" (F-203) and indicated that this item could be included in the Self-Support Packet (F-19) while removing other less effective pieces; regarding future International Conventions, it was suggested that measures be considered to assure self-support through registration activities and that the feasibility of a separate ongoing Convention Fund be considered; when dealing with items such as the World Service Meeting and related activities, it was suggested that the General Service Board consider the spiritual message of self-support in its spending priorities.

GRAPEVINE

The 2016 Grapevine Office Report on Audio Strategy was reviewed and a request made for updated information on the project to be provided to the 2017 Conference Committee on the Grapevine; suggestions were forwarded to the Grapevine board to produce books with the working titles "Stories by Atheist and Agnostic AA Members" and "Steps Four and Five" in 2017 or later; the committee reviewed the Grapevine Workbook.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

Providing more information about Regional Forums, including event details on local Area websites, suggestions to "bring a buddy" and informing members outside the Region about upcoming Forums were highlighted as ways to encourage interest and attract first time attendees; noting that the 2015 International Convention showed a loss, the committee discussed ongoing efforts by G.S.O. and the General Service Board to plan effectively for the 2020 International Convention in Detroit, Michigan, as well as recognizing positive new features from the 2015 Convention such as the Anonymity Booth and the Carry the Message Pavilion, along with the participation of over 700 A.A. members who are deaf.

LITERATURE

After discussion, no action was taken on a request to produce a plain language version of the Big Book and

¹Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.

a report from A.A.W.S. on “pagination” of Conference-approved digital texts was accepted with encouragement that A.A.W.S. continue to investigate all possible solutions; the committee reviewed progress reports from the trustees’ committee on the revision of the pamphlets “A.A. for the Woman,” “A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic” and the development of literature for A.A.s with mental health issues and those who sponsor them, and looks forward reviewing draft copy, revisions or progress reports on these items at the 2017 Conference; suggestions for the revised draft pamphlet “Inside A.A.: Understanding the Fellowship and Its Services” were offered to the trustees’ Literature Committee for consideration when a revised draft or progress report is brought to the 2017 Conference; it was suggested that the need for “plain-language” recovery literature be explored by the trustees’ Literature Committee.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

The committee suggested that G.S.O. and the trustees’ committee on the General Service Conference explore ways to provide information to and encourage coordinated efforts among local translation committees regarding translation of Conference background into French and Spanish; regarding Conference observers from other fellowships, the committee took no action, noting that the General Service Conference is a closed business meeting and that A.A. freely shares its experience upon request; recognizing that current practices are sufficient and in keeping with the Conference Charter, the committee took no action on a request that all Conference members be sent the same background material with the exception

of digital media and works in progress; it was suggested that the trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference consider developing procedures for electronic polling to be used only in matters of grave emergency that may occur between Conferences and that are in keeping with the Conference Charter.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

The committee reviewed and accepted the annual report of the trustees’ P.I. Committee on the G.S.O. and Grapevine websites, the 2016 P.I. Comprehensive Media plan, and information on the distribution, tracking and evaluation of the PSA “Doors”; it was suggested that the trustees’ P.I. Committee explore ways of providing guidance to the Fellowship on carrying the A.A. message to the general public online and in social media; the P.I. Kit and Workbook were reviewed, noting their usefulness; and the committee took no action on a request to reconsider 2011 Advisory Action 22, as the current policy on the use of full-face videos is adequate.

REPORT AND CHARTER

Reports from the Publishing department regarding preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* and General Service Conference *Final Report* were accepted along with a list of editorial updates from the Publishing department, the General Service Board and the A.A. Grapevine board for *The A.A. Service Manual*; a suggestion was made to include a definition of “Service Manual” in the Glossary of Service Terms in *The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service*; adding text to the chart



on page S22 regarding the “Third Legacy Procedure” was suggested for consistency; the Publishing department was asked to consider using a larger font for the *Final Report* and including call-out text on the cover to highlight potential items of interest.

TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

The committee suggested creation of an Accessibilities Checklist for the Special Needs/Accessibilities Kit that groups could use to inventory their accessibility to all alcoholics and that inclusion of the A.A. Guidelines on Carrying the Message to the Deaf Alcoholic in the Treatment Kit be reviewed.

TRUSTEES

After a review of resumes, all Class B trustee candidates for the West Central and Western Canada regions were approved as eligible; the committee discussed a report from the trustees’ Committee on Nominating regarding expanding the pool of candidates to serve the General Service Board and the Corporate Boards and encouraged consultation between the trustees’ Committee on Nominating and the General Service Board to identify the skills and backgrounds most needed for each opening; while direct questions on the candidate’s resume form regarding diverse characteristics was determined unnecessary, the committee suggested adding space to the current resume form that would allow candidates to provide additional background that might benefit the General Service Board.

Recommendations That Did Not Result In Conference Advisory Actions

FINANCE

- The committee recommended that the maximum annual limit for individual contributions to the General Service Board from A.A. members be increased from \$3,000 to \$5,000

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee recommended that background material continue to be provided in English because it is not feasible at this time to move forward with translation of Conference background into French and Spanish

Floor Actions That Did Not Result In Conference Advisory Actions

- That the trustees’ Committee on Public Information begin work on a Google-for-Nonprofit account to be used for carrying the A.A. message to the public. This request is limited to “YouTube for Nonprofit” to share video content and “Google Ad Words” which will help in search result placement. The trustees’ committee is asked to provide

a progress report to the 2017 Conference Committee on Public Information. **(Not approved)**

- That the standing agenda items on the Conference Finance Committee which read as follows:

1. To review the contribution for delegate expense for the General Service Conference.
2. To approve individual bequests to the General Service Board from A.A. members.
3. To review maximum annual contribution to the General Service Board from an individual A.A. member of \$3,000.

be removed as standing items on the Conference Finance Committee agenda. **(Not approved)**

- That a subscription app for La Viña be created with the same technical components as the A.A. Grapevine app. **(Withdrawn by submitter)**

- That 2-3 hours be provided in the 67th Conference agenda to permit the Conference to consult on matters brought forward by the trustees of the General Service Board. **(Not approved)**

- That the minutes of the General Service Board meetings be posted to the General Service Conference dashboard as soon as they are approved so that all Area delegates have equal access to the minutes. **(Withdrawn by submitter)**

